11.4 Surgical Wound Care*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The wound is wet and smells." **Objective** • Redness spreading 2 cm beyond the incision • Pus • Temperature 38.2 ℃	**ACTUAL** Impaired tissue integrity related to wound infection as evidenced by erythema, purulent discharge and fever.	• Less redness and discharge within 72 hours.	• Take a wound swab as ordered. • Dress the wound aseptically as prescribed. • Give antibiotics as prescribed. • Record the wound's appearance every shift.	• Met as the wound improves.
Subjective • Rates wound pain 5/10 **Objective** • Tender wound • Guards when moving	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to wound inflammation as evidenced by a pain score of 5/10.	• Pain at or below 3/10.	• Give analgesia before dressing changes. • Handle the wound gently. • Use non-adherent dressings.	• Achieved when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Obesity • Abdominal wound under tension	**RISK** Risk for impaired tissue integrity as evidenced by risk factors: obesity, wound infection and raised intra-abdominal pressure from coughing (wound dehiscence).	• Wound edges stay together.	• Teach her to support the wound when coughing. • Apply an abdominal binder if ordered. • Report more serous drainage, which can come before dehiscence.	• Outcome reached if the wound stays intact.

* **References for this care plan:** [7], [32], [35], [90]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.